Brighter Days

150+ Activities for Seniors

Simple, engaging ways to support memory, conversation, movement, and joy.



Boost Memory

Encourage Conversation

Support Movement

Bring Joy

MEMORY & REASONING

Puzzles, word games and brain teasers to keep the mind active and sharp.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

45 activities

2 Finish the Saying ●●○
4 Say the Color! ●●○
6 Number Gym ●●○
8 Rhyme Time ●●○
10 Shape Sudoku ●●●
12 Sock Hop Word Search ●●○
14 Golden Age Movie Trivia ●●○
18 Then & Now ●○○
22 Kitchen Word Scramble ●●○
24 Odd One Out ●○○
26 Name Five! ●●○
28 Finish the Picture ●●●
30 Road Trip USA ●●○
32 Missing Vowels ●●○
35 Alphabet Garden ●●○
37 Grocery List Memory ●●●
39 Opposites Match ●○○
42 Perfect Pairs ●○○
45 Put It in Order ●●○
49 Finish the Lyric ●●○
53 Crossword: Around the House ●●●
57 Garden Party Word Search ●●○
61 Spot the Difference: Picnic Day ●●○
65 Find the Way Home ●●○
69 Counting Coins ●●○
73 What Time Is It? ●○○
76 Swinging Sixties Trivia ●●○
80 Word Ladder ●●●
85 Hidden Animals ●●○
89 Connect the Dots: Sailboat ●○○
93 Number Search ●●○
97 Around the World A to Z ●●●
100 Picture Memory ●●○
104 Missing Letters: U.S. States ●●○
108 Mixed-Up Sentences ●●○
112 Count the Shapes ●○○
116 Baseball Legends Trivia ●●○
121 Christmas Cheer Word Search ●●○
125 Complete the Pattern ●○○
128 Recipe Math ●●●
132 Compound Words ●●○
136 Sounds Alike ●●○
140 Who Owns the Cat? ●●●
144 Fourth of July Word Search ●●○
148 Classic TV Trivia ●●○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

Gentle movement, hand skills and seated games for every ability.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

35 activities

15 Seated Hand Dance ●○○
19 Little Pot Garden ●○○
21 Sponge Painting ●○○
29 Balloon Volleyball ●○○
31 Shadow Theater ●●○
41 Finger Painting ●○○
43 Clay Sculpting ●●○
51 Chair Yoga Flow ●○○
55 Seated March Along ●○○
59 Ball Pass Circle ●○○
63 Beanbag Toss ●○○
66 Ribbon Dance ●○○
70 Finger Gym ●○○
74 Wheelchair Bowling ●○○
78 Seated Tai Chi ●●○
81 Good Morning Stretch ●○○
84 Walk & Talk Club ●●○
88 Paper Plate Frisbee ●○○
92 Hot Potato ●○○
95 Seated Simon Says ●○○
99 Cup Stacking Challenge ●●○
102 Pool Noodle Hockey ●●○
106 Kitchen Dance Party ●○○
109 Balloon Tennis ●○○
113 Button Sorting ●○○
117 Lacing Cards ●●○
120 Bead a Bracelet ●●○
123 Easy Paper Folding ●●○
127 Finger Knitting ●●●
131 Bubble Fun ●○○
135 Tabletop Mini Golf ●●○
138 Weave a Placemat ●●○
142 Seated Drum Circle ●○○
146 Towel Stretch ●○○
150 Clothespin Challenge ●●○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

CONTENTS

PART 3 OF 4

FAMILY CONNECTION

Stories, traditions and moments that bring generations together.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

35 activities

1 The Memory Jar ●○○
5 A Recipe to Remember ●○○
11 Life Story Bingo ●○○
13 Letters from the Heart ●●○
23 Family Photo Puzzle ●●○
36 The Memory Phone Call ●○○
46 Memory Scrapbook ●●○
47 My Favorite Things ●○○
48 Thanksgiving Memories ●○○
52 My Family Tree ●●○
56 Grandchild Interview ●○○
60 Recreate an Old Photo ●○○
64 Baking Grandma's Cookies ●○○
68 The Story of My Name ●○○
71 My First Car ●○○
75 Wedding Day Memories ●○○
79 Christmas Memories ●○○
83 Fourth of July Picnic ●○○
87 Valentine Love Notes ●○○
90 Easter Egg Decorating ●○○
94 Pumpkin Painting ●○○
98 Birthday Memory Book ●●○
103 Letter to Future Generations ●●○
107 Video Call Show & Tell ●○○
110 Family Checkers Night ●●○
114 Grandparent Advice Cards ●○○
118 Map of My Life ●●○
122 Hometown Memories ●○○
126 Teach Me Your Skill ●●○
130 Family Sing-Along ●○○
133 Pets We've Loved ●○○
137 School Days ●○○
141 Handmade Greeting Cards ●●○
145 Family Photo Wall ●●○
149 Thank-You Letters ●●○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

MOOD & WELL-BEING

Laughter, calm and small joys that brighten every single day.



LEVEL ●○○ Easy ●●○ Medium ●●● Challenging

35 activities

3 The Senses Box ●○○
7 Name That Tune ●○○
9 The Gratitude Tree ●○○
16 Garden Mandala ●○○
17 What's That Sound? ●○○
20 Build-a-Sundae Social ●○○
25 Balloon Breathing ●○○
27 Tastes of Life ●○○
33 Homemade Aromatherapy ●○○
34 Color Dominoes ●●○
38 Dream Board ●●○
40 Color Race ●○○
44 Guided Meditation ●○○
50 Hand Spa Day ●○○
54 The Joke Jar ●○○
58 Laughter Yoga ●○○
62 Afternoon Tea Party ●○○
67 Backyard Bird Watching ●○○
72 Sock Puppet Show ●●○
77 Nature Scavenger Hunt ●○○
82 Karaoke Classics ●○○
86 Movie Afternoon ●○○
91 Warm Foot Soak ●○○
96 Watercolor Postcards ●●○
101 Pet Therapy Visit ●○○
105 Coloring Page: Country Barn ●○○
111 Coloring Page: By the Sea ●○○
115 Riddle Time ●●○
119 Magnetic Fishing Game ●○○
124 Silly Hat Parade ●○○
129 Sunshine Break ●○○
134 Positive Words Cards ●○○
139 Funny Captions ●●○
143 Aquarium Calm ●○○
147 Bubble Wrap Pop ●○○

Choose by goal, pick the right level — and enjoy!

PET THERAPY VISIT

A wagging tail and a soft head to pet. Calm and joy in minutes.



BEFORE THE VISIT

- [x] Check for allergies
- [x] Ask about fear of animals
- [x] Choose a calm, gentle pet
- [x] Have hand wipes ready

STEP BY STEP

1 SAY HELLO
Let the pet sniff your hand.



2 PET GENTLY
Slow strokes on the back.



3 TALK
Tell the pet about your day.



4 SAY GOODBYE
A treat and a smile.



PET TALK

- Did you have a pet growing up?
- What was its name?
- Cats or dogs?



CAREGIVER TIP

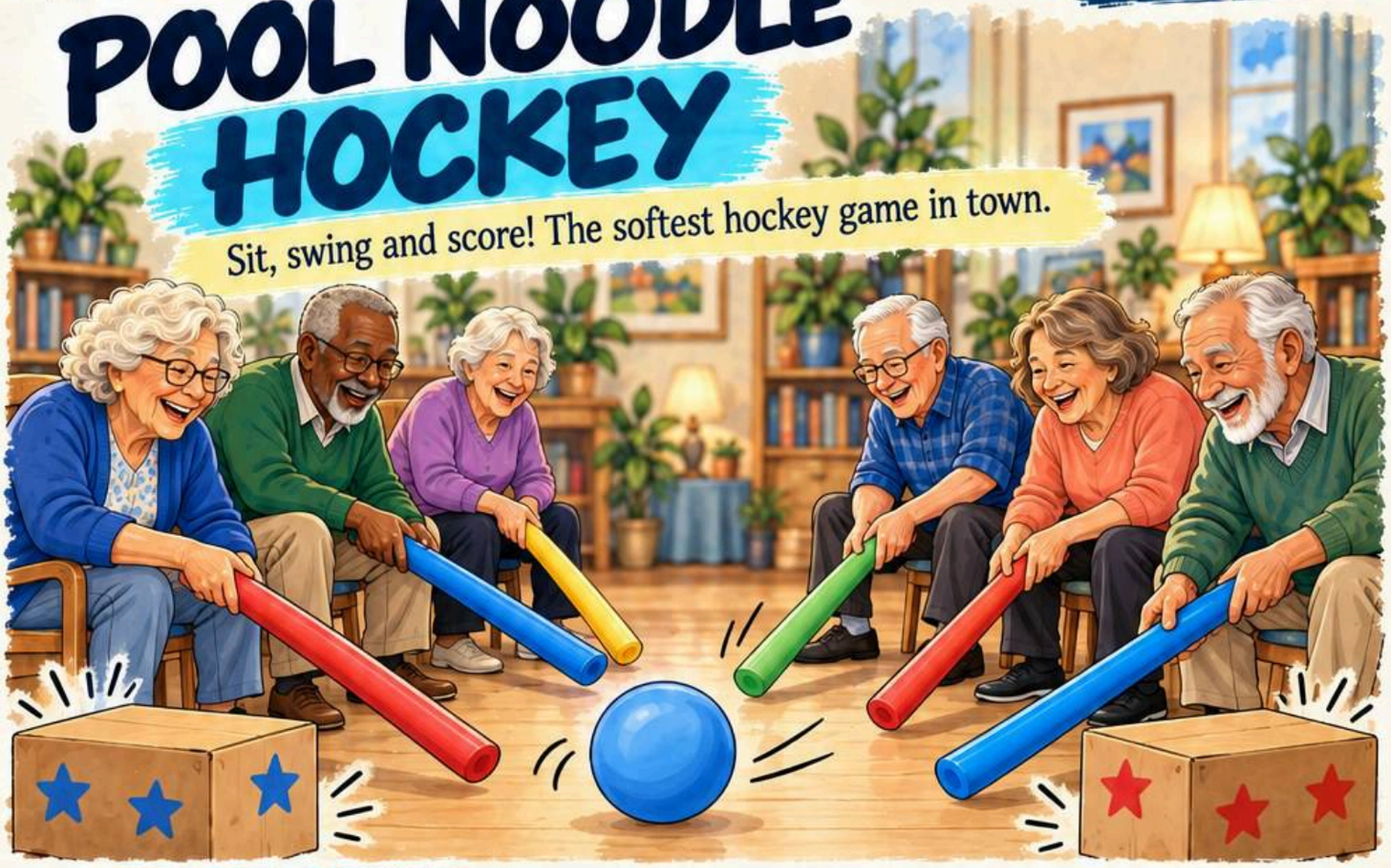
Short visits of 10 to 15 minutes work best.

ACTIVITY 102

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

POOL NOODLE HOCKEY

Sit, swing and score! The softest hockey game in town.



STEP BY STEP

1 MAKE TEAMS
Two rows of chairs facing each other.



2 GRAB A NOODLE
One pool noodle each.



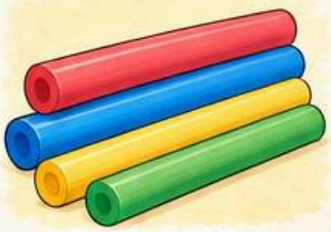
3 PLAY
Push the ball toward the other team's goal.



4 SCORE
First team to 5 wins!



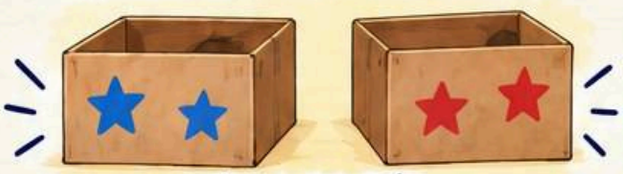
MATERIALS NEEDED



Pool noodles



A soft ball or balloon



2 boxes as goals

SCORE

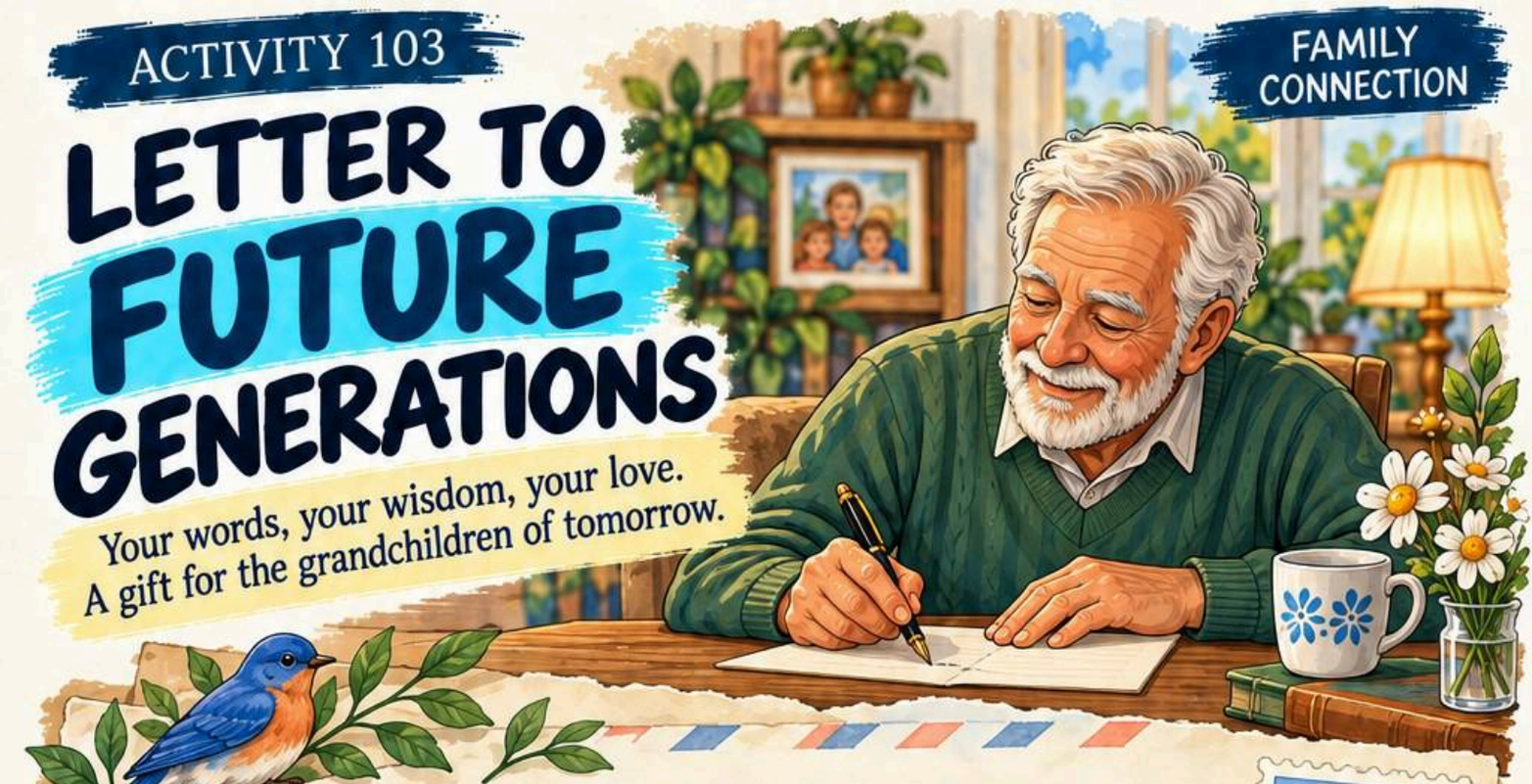
Team 1	Team 2
☐☐☐☐☐	☐☐☐☐☐

CAREGIVER TIP

Keep feet flat on the floor and stay seated for safety.

LETTER TO FUTURE GENERATIONS

Your words, your wisdom, your love.
A gift for the grandchildren of tomorrow.



Dear _____,

When I was young, the world was...

_____

_____

_____

The most important thing I learned is...

_____

_____

_____

I hope you always...

_____

_____

_____

With love, _____



CAREGIVER TIP

Offer to write while they speak.
Keep it in a family album.

ACTIVITY 104

MEMORY & REASONING

MISSING LETTERS: U.S. STATES



Fill in the missing letters to name each state.

1.  F L _ R I D _ 

2.  T E X _ S 

3.  _ L A S K A 

4.  N E W Y _ R K 

5.  C A L I F _ R N I A 

6.  G E _ R G I A 

7.  A R I Z _ N A 

8.  O H _ O 

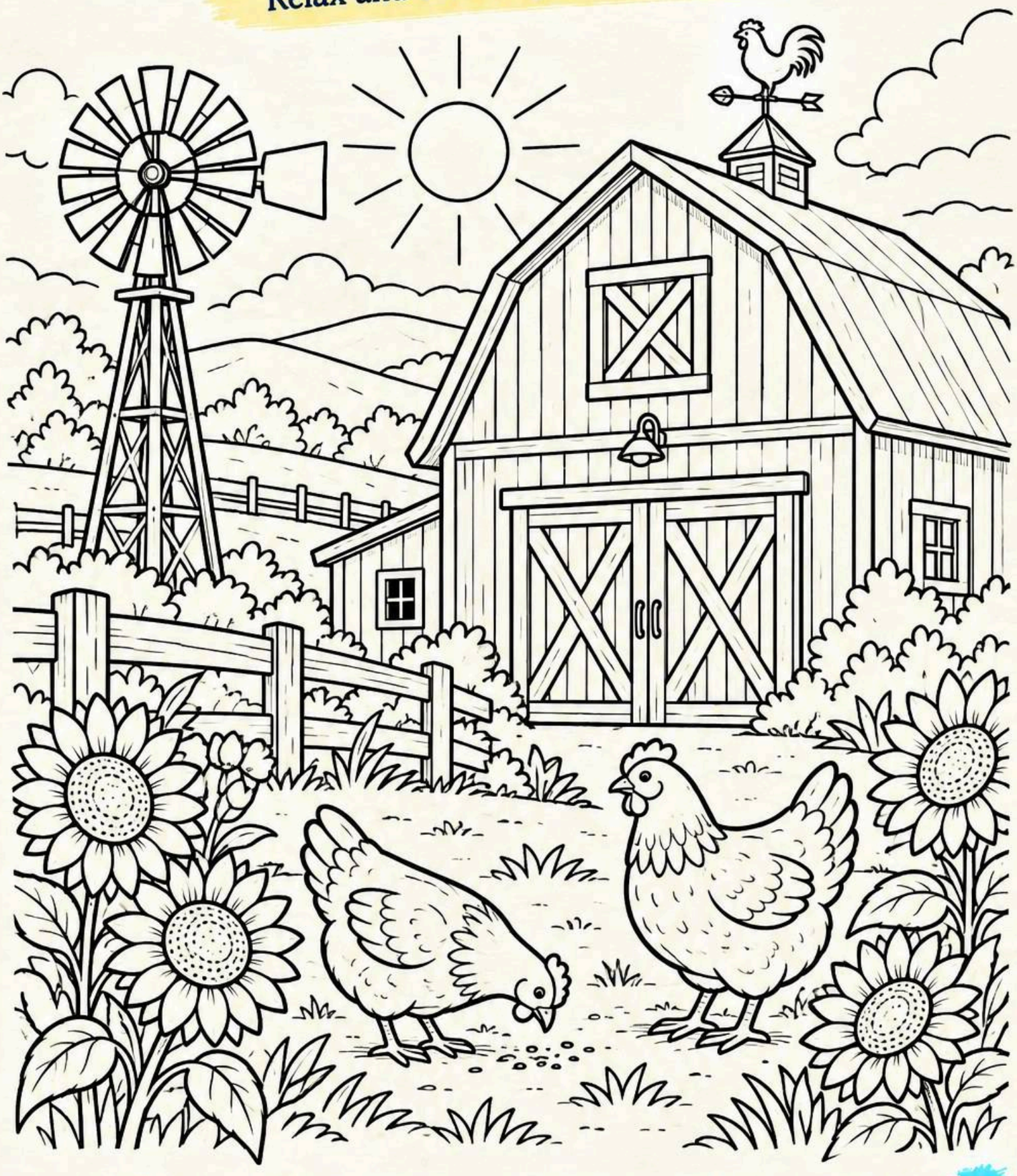
9.  M _ N T A N A 

10.  V E R M _ N T 

ANSWERS: FLORIDA · TEXAS · ALASKA · NEW YORK · CALIFORNIA · GEORGIA · ARIZONA · OHIO · MONTANA · VERMONT

COLORING PAGE: COUNTRY BARN

Relax and color at your own pace.



ACTIVITY 106

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

KITCHEN DANCE PARTY

Turn up the radio and dance like nobody's watching!



PLAYLIST

- In the Mood
- Rock Around the Clock
- Twist and Shout
- Dancing Queen
- Hound Dog
- Shake, Rattle and Roll
- Moon River
- Sway



STEP BY STEP

1 CLEAR A LITTLE SPACE
Nothing to trip on.



2 PRESS PLAY
Pick a favorite oldie.



3 MOVE
Sway, step, clap or dance sitting down.



CAREGIVER TIP

Hold hands or the counter for balance. Seated dancing counts!



ACTIVITY 107

FAMILY CONNECTION

VIDEO CALL SHOW & TELL

Far away, but close at heart. Share a special object on a video call.



SHOW & TELL IDEAS



An old photo



A medal or award



A favorite book



A piece of jewelry



A recipe card



A souvenir

STEP BY STEP

1 PICK AN OBJECT

Something with a story.



2 SCHEDULE THE CALL

A time that works for everyone.



3 SHOW IT

Hold it close to the camera.



4 TELL THE STORY

Where it came from and why it matters.



CAREGIVER TIP

Set up the tablet on a stand so hands are free.



ACTIVITY 108

MEMORY & REASONING

MIXED-UP SENTENCES

Put the words in the right order to make a sentence.



1 dog | the | barks



2 is | sky | the | blue



3 tea | like | I | hot



4 garden | flowers | the | has | many



5 bakes | Grandma | pies | apple



6 rains | it | spring | in | often



7 the | sings | bird | morning | every



8 family | love | I | my

ANSWERS: The dog barks. · The sky in blue. · I like hot tea. · The garden has many flowers. · Grandma bakes apple pies. · It often rains in spring. · The bird sings every morning. · I love my family.

ACTIVITY 109

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

BALLOON TENNIS

Light, slow and so much fun.
Everyone can play tennis!



HOW TO MAKE A RACKET



Tape a paper plate to a paint stirrer or wooden spoon.

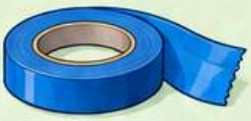
MATERIALS NEEDED



Paper plates



Wooden sticks



Tape



Balloons

STEP BY STEP

1 MAKE RACKETS

One for each player.



2 BLOW UP A BALLOON

Not too full.



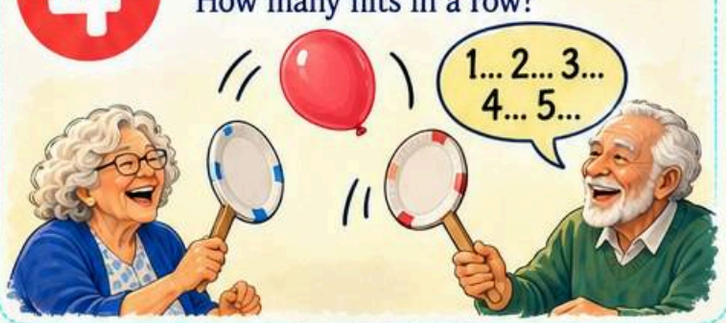
3 HIT IT BACK AND FORTH

Keep it in the air.



4 COUNT

How many hits in a row?



CAREGIVER TIP

Check for latex allergies first.

ACTIVITY 110

FAMILY CONNECTION

FAMILY CHECKERS NIGHT

One board, two generations, endless smiles.



THE STARTING SETUP



Each player starts with 12 pieces, placed on the dark squares.

QUICK RULES

1. Move diagonally forward one square.



2. Jump over an opponent's piece to capture it.



3. Reach the last row to become a King!



4. Kings can move backward.



FAMILY SCORE

PLAYER	WINS
Grandpa	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Grandchild	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Mom	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Dad	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Other	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

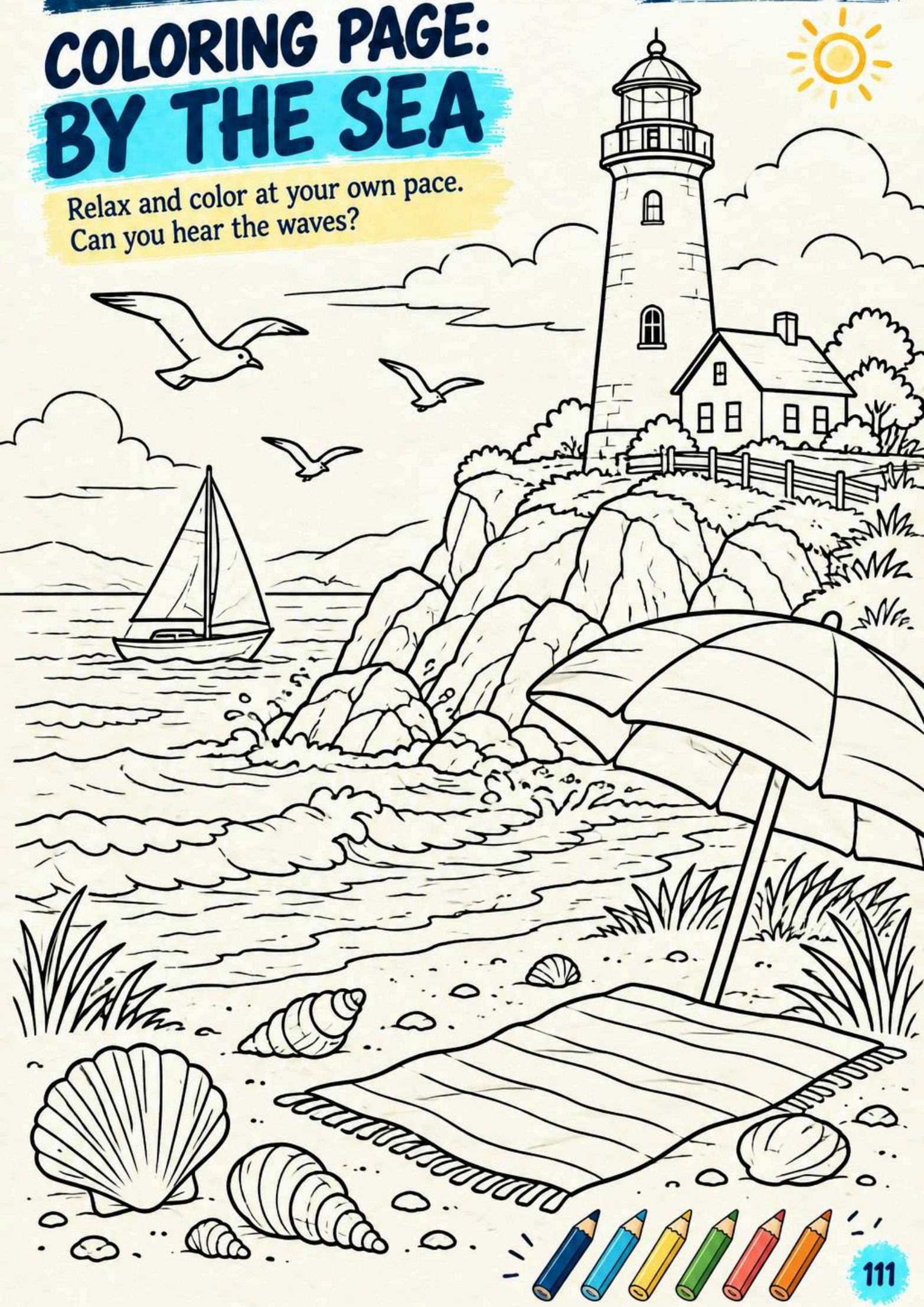
CAREGIVER TIP

Let the grandparent teach the rules. They'll love being the expert.



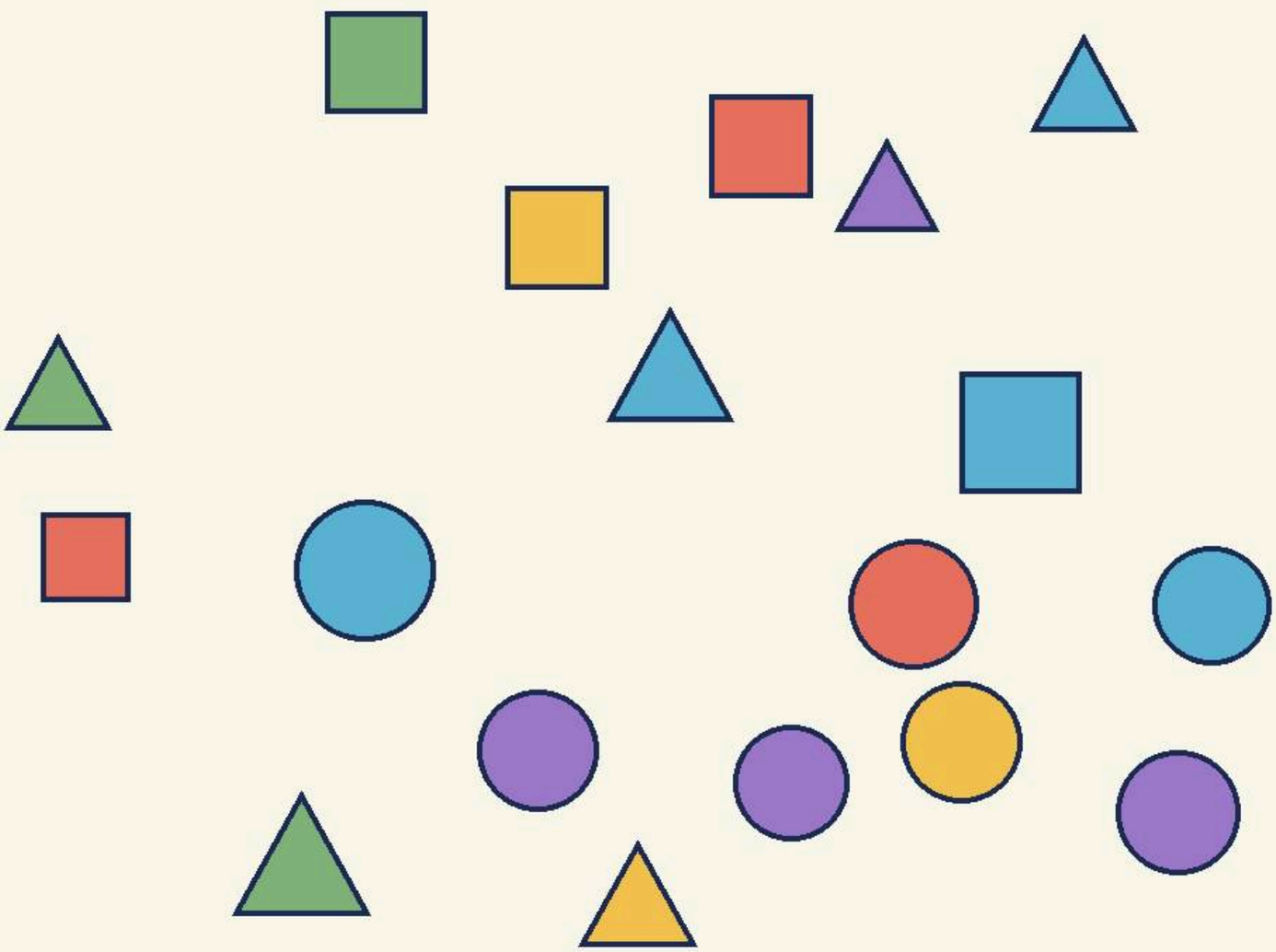
COLORING PAGE: BY THE SEA

Relax and color at your own pace.
Can you hear the waves?



COUNT THE SHAPES

Count each kind of shape in the picture.
Touch each one as you count!



ANSWERS: 7 circles · 5 squares · 6 triangles

HOW MANY?

Circles: _____

Squares: _____

Triangles: _____

ACTIVITY 113

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

BUTTON SORTING

Pick, look, sort. A calm game for busy hands.



GAME IDEAS

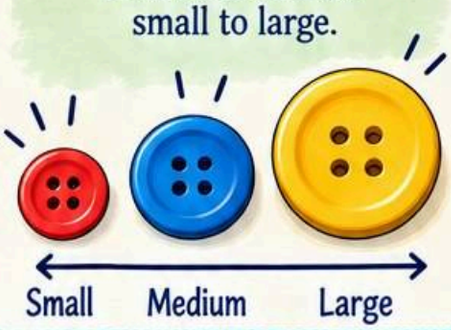
BY COLOR

Sort buttons by color.



BY SIZE

Sort buttons from small to large.



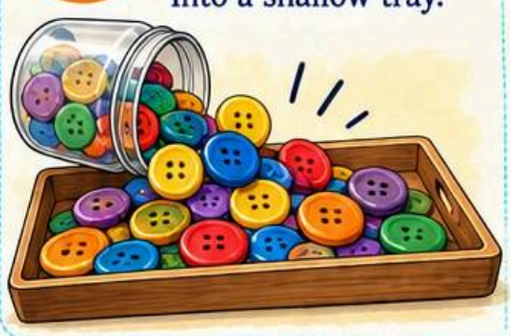
BY NUMBER OF HOLES

Sort buttons by how many holes they have.



STEP BY STEP

1 POUR THE BUTTONS
Into a shallow tray.



2 CHOOSE A GAME
Color, size or holes.



3 SORT
One button at a time into the muffin tin.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Big buttons



Muffin tin or bowls



A tray

CAREGIVER TIP

Use large buttons only and supervise. Never leave small items alone with someone who might swallow them.

GRANDPARENT ADVICE CARDS



A lifetime of wisdom, one card at a time.
Write it, gift it, keep it. ♡

About love... ♡



About money...



About work...



About friendship...



About hard times...



About family...



About happiness...



The best advice I ever got...

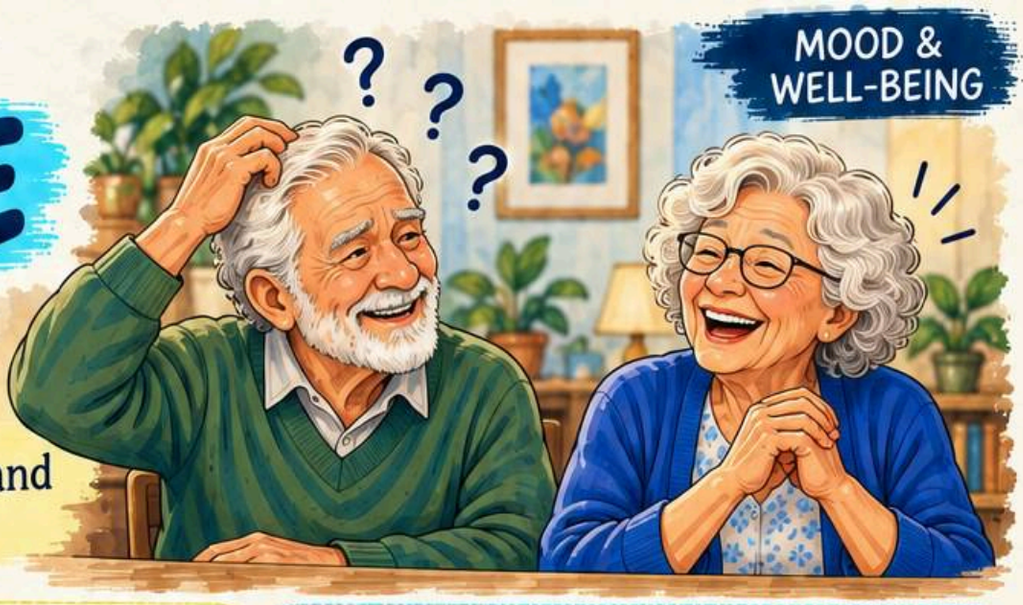


CAREGIVER TIP Laminate the cards and give them as a gift to the grandchildren. ♡

ACTIVITY 115

MOOD & WELL-BEING

RIDDLE TIME



Read a riddle out loud and let everyone guess!

1 What has keys but can't open locks?



A piano

2 What gets wetter the more it dries?



A towel

3 What has a face and two hands but no arms?



A clock

4 What goes up but never comes down?



Your age

5 What has many teeth but can't bite?



A comb

6 What can you catch but not throw?



A cold

7 What has a neck but no head?



A bottle

8 What runs but never walks?



Water

CAREGIVER TIP

Give hints if needed.
The fun is in guessing together.

BASEBALL LEGENDS TRIVIA



Batter up! Circle the right answer.

1 

Who was called "The Babe"?

A Babe Ruth B Babe Smith C Babe Lee

2 

Who broke baseball's color barrier in 1947?

A Jackie Robinson B Hank Aaron C Willie Mays

3 

Which team played in Yankee Stadium?

A Red Sox B New York Yankees C Dodgers

4 

How many strikes make an out?

A 2 B 3 C 4

5 

Which player was "The Iron Horse"?

A Lou Gehrig B Ty Cobb C Joe DiMaggio

6 

What song is sung during the 7th inning stretch?

A "Take Me Out to the Ball Game" B "Yankee Doodle" C "Jingle Bells"

7 

How many players are on the field for one team?

A 7 B 9 C 11

8 

Which player was called "Joltin' Joe"?

A Joe DiMaggio B Joe Namath C Joe Louis

9 

A hit that clears the bases with 4 runners is a...

A Grand slam B Triple C Bunt

10 

The Brooklyn Dodgers moved to...

A Chicago B Los Angeles C Boston



ANSWERS (Upside down!): 1·2A · 2A · 3B · 3B · 4B · 6B · 7B · 9A · 9A · 10B

LACING CARDS

In, out, in, out. A calming craft that keeps fingers nimble.



CARD IDEAS



Apple



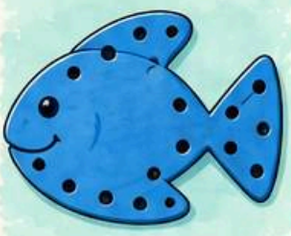
Heart



Star



House



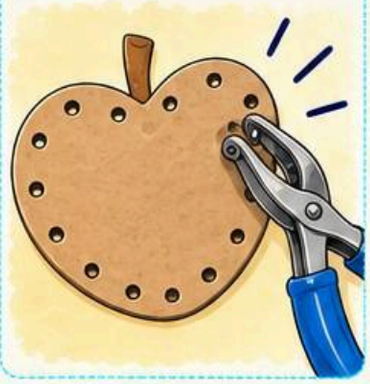
Fish

STEP BY STEP

1 CUT A SHAPE
From thick cardboard.



2 PUNCH HOLES
Around the edges.



3 LACE IT
A shoelace or yarn with tape on the tip.



4 FINISH
Tie a bow!



MATERIALS NEEDED



Cardboard



Hole punch



Shoelaces or yarn



Tape

CAREGIVER TIP

Bigger holes and a thicker lace make it easier.

MAP OF MY LIFE

Mark the places that shaped your life, and tell the story of each one.





PLACES OF MY LIFE

1. I was born in _____
2. I grew up in _____
3. I went to school in _____
4. I got married in _____
5. I lived longest in _____
6. A place I loved to visit _____

CAREGIVER TIP

Use colored stickers for each place and connect them with a line.

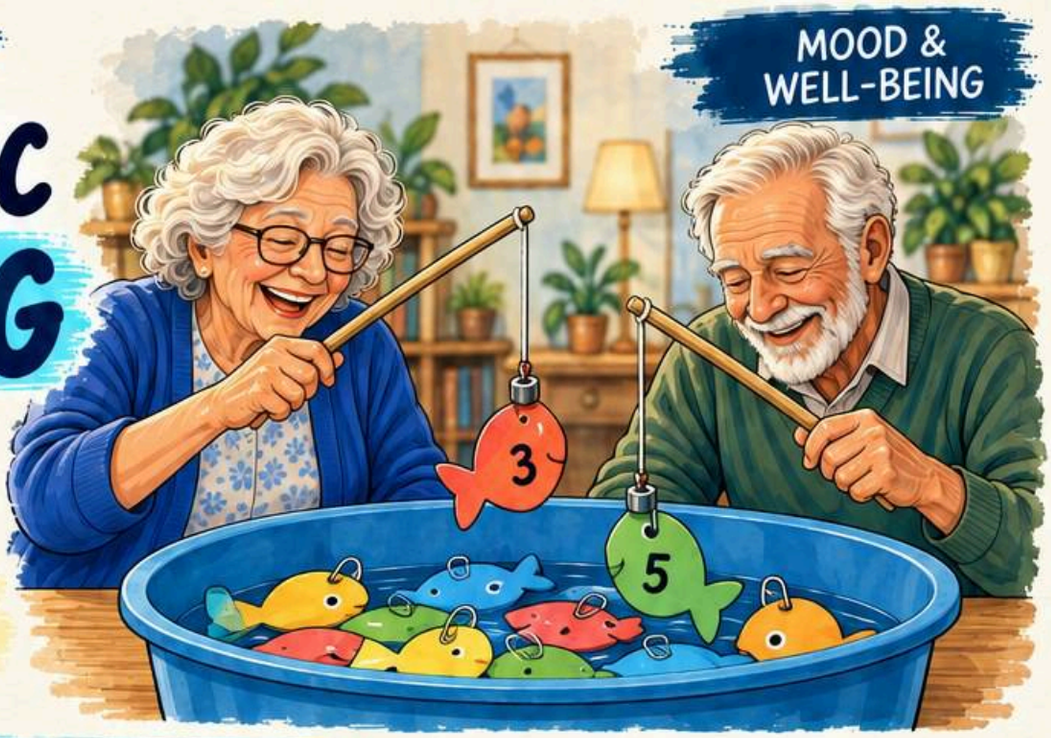


ACTIVITY 119

MOOD & WELL-BEING

MAGNETIC FISHING GAME

Cast your line and catch a smile!



FISH TEMPLATES (Cut out and use!)



1 point | 2 points | 3 points | 4 points | 5 points | 6 points

STEP BY STEP

1 MAKE THE FISH
Cut paper fish and add a paper clip.



2 MAKE THE RODS
A stick, a string and a magnet.



3 GO FISHING
Catch as many as you can.



4 COUNT POINTS
Add the numbers on your fish.



2 + 3 + 4 = 9

MATERIALS NEEDED



Colored paper



Paper clips



Magnets



Sticks and string

CAREGIVER TIP

Use a big tub and large fish so everyone catches some.

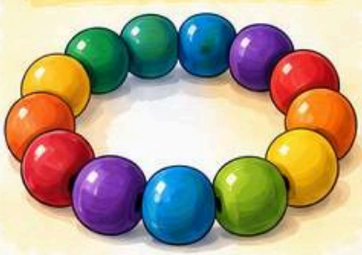
BEAD A BRACELET

Choose your colors and make something beautiful to wear or to give.

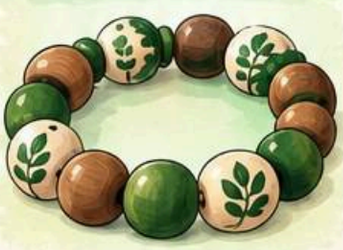


PATTERN IDEAS

Rainbow Bright



Nature Mix



Classic Combo



Pretty in Pink



STEP BY STEP

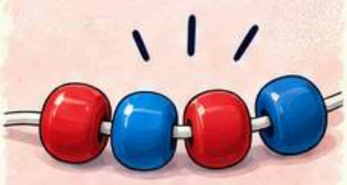
1 MEASURE

Wrap the cord around the wrist and add a little extra.



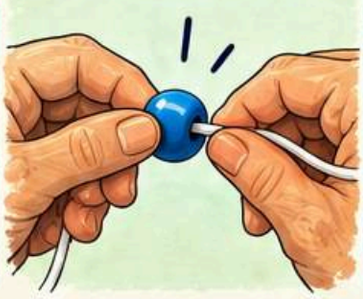
2 PLAN A PATTERN

Red, blue, red, blue...



3 THREAD

One bead at a time.



4 TIE IT

A double knot.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Large wooden beads



Stretchy cord



Scissors



A tray

CAREGIVER TIP

Tape one end of the cord to the table so beads don't slide off.



ACTIVITY 121

MEMORY & REASONING

CHRISTMAS CHEER WORD SEARCH

Find the 10 words. They go across or down.



T	L	S	G	A	P	G	V	N	E	B	E
R	P	N	T	T	G	C	A	R	O	L	H
D	M	O	C	I	B	B	I	G	G	D	F
O	L	W	O	P	V	G	S	T	A	R	P
G	K	M	O	N	W	R	E	A	T	H	P
A	H	A	K	T	G	T	D	K	K	T	P
T	I	N	I	O	A	N	G	E	L	P	S
N	L	A	E	B	Y	W	C	A	N	D	Y
T	G	P	S	S	A	N	T	A	L	B	U
P	L	Y	R	L	S	L	E	I	G	H	Y
H	N	U	U	Y	V	O	K	M	V	T	C
T	G	I	F	T	S	T	R	T	U	U	B

FIND THESE WORDS



- ☐ SANTA



- ☐ SLEIGH



- ☐ CANDY



- ☐ WREATH



- ☐ GIFTS



- ☐ ANGEL



- ☐ STAR



- ☐ CAROL



- ☐ COOKIES

- ☐ SNOWMAN



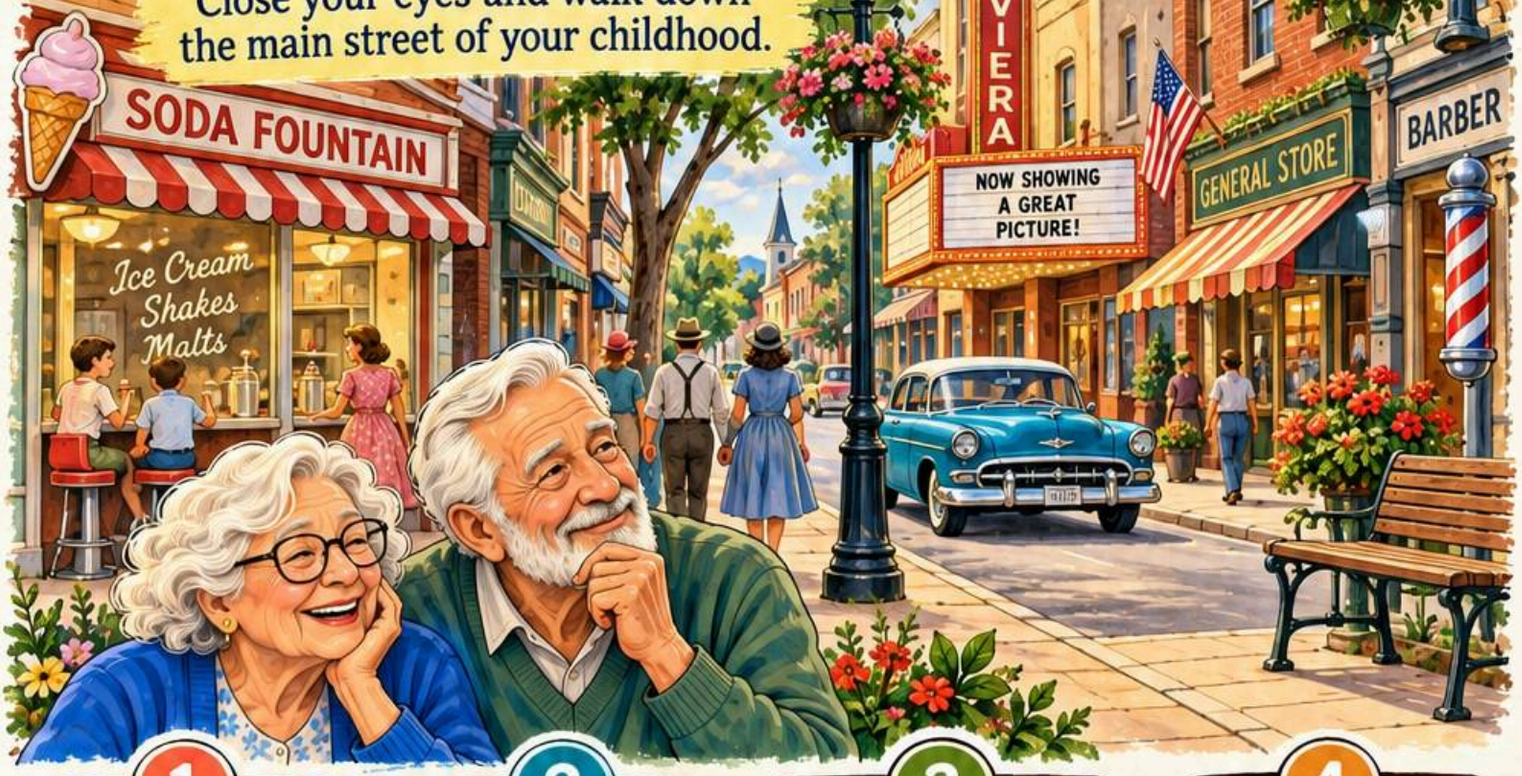
HOMETOWN MEMORIES

Close your eyes and walk down the main street of your childhood.

MY HOMETOWN

Town _____

State _____



1 What was your town's name?



2 Where did you buy candy?



3 What was the movie theater like?



4 Who were your neighbors?



5 Where did kids play?



6 What did your house look like?



7 What smell reminds you of home?



8 Have you gone back to visit?



CAREGIVER TIP

Search for old photos of the town online and look together.



ACTIVITY 123

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

EASY PAPER FOLDING

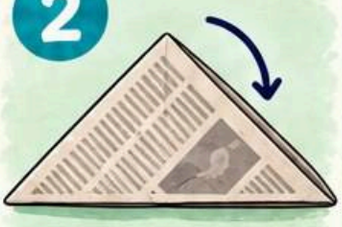
A sheet of paper becomes a hat or a boat. Simple, satisfying and fun.



PAPER HAT



1. Place the paper horizontally.



2. Fold in half to make a triangle.



3. Fold up the bottom edges on both sides.



4. Open and wear your hat!

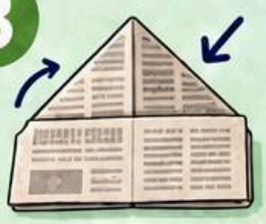
PAPER BOAT



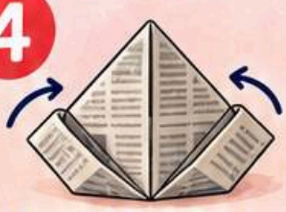
1. Place the paper horizontally.



2. Fold in half (from top to bottom).



3. Fold the top corners down to make a triangle.



4. Fold up the bottom edges on both sides, then open into a square and fold again.



5. Gently open your boat and it's ready to float!

MATERIALS NEEDED



Rectangular paper (letter size or newspaper)



A flat table

CAREGIVER TIP

Fold together, step by step, at the same speed.

SILLY HAT PARADE

Decorate a hat, show it off, and laugh until your cheeks hurt!



HAT IDEAS


Fruit basket hat


Garden hat


Bird nest hat


Pirate hat


Crown


Party hat

PRIZE CATEGORIES


Funniest


Most colorful


Most creative

CAREGIVER TIP

Everyone gets a prize. Take lots of photos!



COMPLETE THE PATTERN

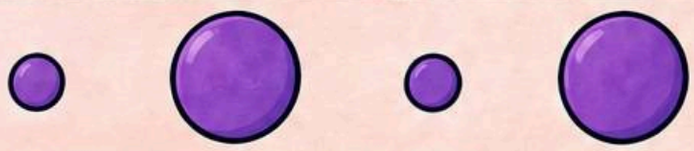


Look at the pattern and draw the next two shapes.

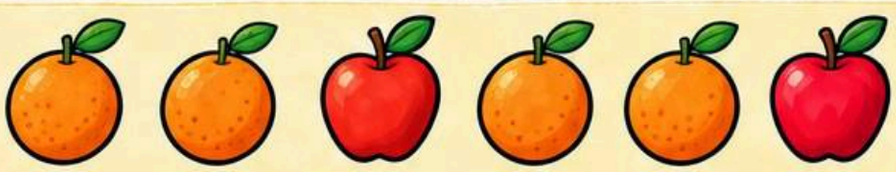
1 

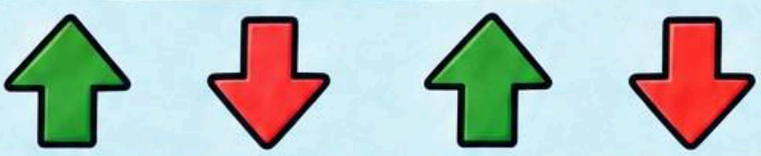
2 

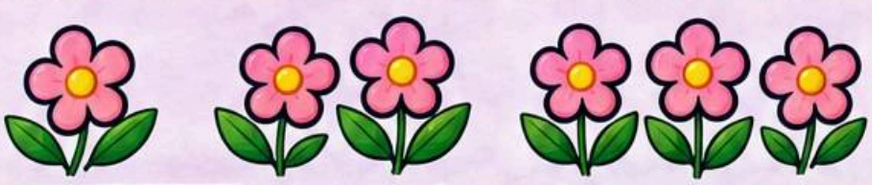
3 

4 

5 

6 

7 

8 

ANSWERS: red, blue · star, star · yellow square, green triangle · small, big · sun, cloud · orange, orange · up, down · 4 flowers, 5 flowers

TEACH ME YOUR SKILL

You know so much!
Today, you are the teacher. ♡



SKILLS I CAN TEACH

- [ ] Knitting
- [ ] A family recipe
- [ ] Tying a tie
- [ ] Fixing things
- [ ] Gardening
- [ ] A card game
- [ ] Sewing a button
- [ ] Writing in cursive
- [ ] Fishing knots
- [ ] An old song

MY LESSON PLAN

1. _____
   _____
2. _____
   _____
3. _____
   _____



CAREGIVER TIP

Let them lead and ask lots of questions. Feeling useful is powerful. ♡

ACTIVITY 127

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

FINGER KNITTING

No needles, just your fingers and soft yarn. Relaxing and rewarding.

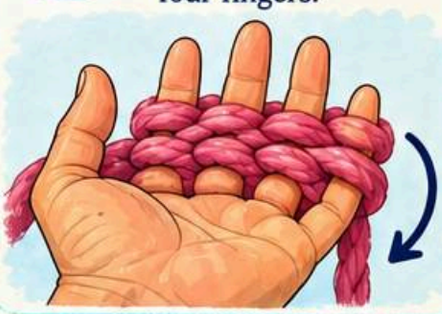


STEP BY STEP

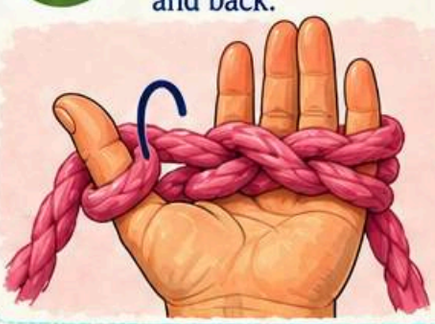
1 TUCK THE TAIL – Between thumb and index finger.



2 WEAVE – Over and under four fingers.



3 WEAVE BACK – Around the pinky and back.



4 REPEAT – Two rows on each finger.



5 LIFT OVER – Bottom loop over the top loop.



6 KEEP GOING – Watch the chain grow!



WHAT TO MAKE



scarf



bookmark



garland

MATERIALS NEEDED



Chunky soft yarn



Scissors

CAREGIVER TIP

Chunky yarn is easier to see and to handle.

ACTIVITY 128

MEMORY & REASONING

RECIPE MATH

Double the recipe for a party, or make half for a quiet afternoon.



CHOCOLATE CHIP COOKIES (makes 24)



2 cups flour



1 cup butter



1 cup sugar



2 eggs



2 tsp vanilla



2 cups chocolate chips

DOUBLE IT (48 cookies)	HALF IT (12 cookies)



ANSWERS: **Double:** 4 cups flour · 2 cups butter · 2 cups sugar · 4 eggs · 4 tsp vanilla · 1 cups chips — **Half:** 1/2 cup flour · 1/2 cup butter · 1/2 cup sugar · 1 egg · 1 tsp vanilla · 1 cup chips

SUNSHINE BREAK

Ten minutes of gentle sunlight and slow breathing. A happy pause.



SUNSHINE BREAK

1 FIND A SPOT
By a sunny window or on the porch.



2 SIT COMFORTABLY
Feet flat, hands on lap.



3 BREATHE
In for 4, out for 6.



4 NOTICE
The warmth, the sounds, the colors.



WHY IT HELPS

- Lifts the mood
- Helps sleep at night
- Gives the body vitamin D



CAREGIVER TIP

Morning or late afternoon sun is gentlest. Wear a hat.



FAMILY SING-ALONG

Voices young and old, singing the same song. Pure joy!



FAMILY SONGBOOK

1. You Are My Sunshine
2. Take Me Home, Country Roads
3. Home on the Range
4. This Land Is Your Land
5. Daisy Bell
6. Over the Rainbow
7. Amazing Grace
8. Happy Birthday

STEP BY STEP

1. **PICK A SONG –** Let each person choose one.
2. **PRINT THE WORDS –** Big and clear.
3. **SING –** No talent needed, only heart!

CAREGIVER TIP

Songs from their teenage years bring the strongest memories.

ACTIVITY 131

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

BUBBLE FUN

Blow, float, pop! Breathing and reaching practice that feels like play.



FUN WAYS TO PLAY

1 Pop with one finger

Watch the bubbles float and try to pop them with one finger.



2 Clap to pop

Clap your hands to pop the bubbles. This helps with coordination and timing.



3 Blow the biggest bubble

Take a deep breath and blow slowly to make the biggest bubble you can!



HOMEMADE BUBBLE MIX



1 cup water

+



2 tbsp dish soap

+



1 tbsp sugar

Mix gently until the sugar dissolves. ♡

CAREGIVER TIP

Play outdoors or on a towel.
Wipe slippery floors right away.



MEMORY & REASONING

COMPOUND WORDS



Put the two words together to make one new word.

1	 sun	+	 flower	=		
2	 rain	+	 bow	=		
3	 butter	+	 fly	=		
4	 star	+	 fish	=		
5	 tooth	+	 brush	=		
6	 pan	+	 cake	=		
7	 snow	+	 man	=		
8	 fire	+	 fly	=		
9	 bed	+	 room	=		
10	 pop	+	 corn	=		

ANSWERS: sunflower · rainbow · toothbrush · pancake · snowman · firefly · bedroom · popcorn.
butterfly · starfish · pancrush · depccrn.

PETS WE'VE LOVED

Every pet leaves paw prints on our hearts. Let's remember them.





MY PET'S NAME

WHAT KIND

FAVORITE TRICK

What was your first pet?

What was its name?

Its funniest habit?

Who took care of it?

A favorite memory together?

If you could have any pet now, what would it be?

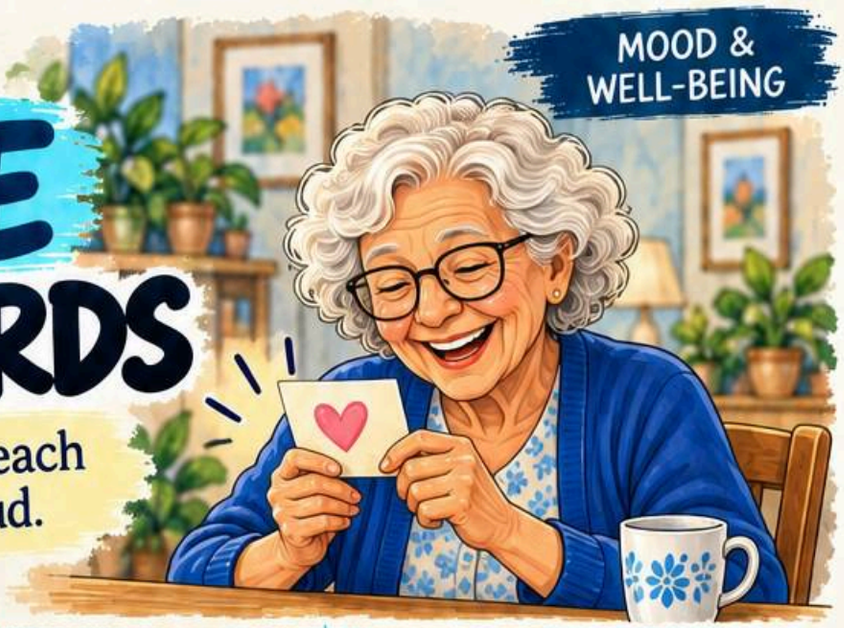
CAREGIVER TIP

Gentle topic: if a memory brings tears, hold their hand and listen.



POSITIVE WORDS CARDS

Cut out the cards. Pick one each morning and read it out loud.



Today is a good day.

I am loved.

Small steps are still steps.

My smile is a gift.

I am stronger than I think.

Every day is a new start.

I am grateful for today.

Kindness is my superpower.

I have so much to share.

Laughter is good medicine.

I am never too old to learn.

Home is where my heart is.

CAREGIVER TIP

Put the card of the day on the fridge or the mirror.



ACTIVITY 135

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

TABLETOP MINI GOLF

Fore! A whole golf course on your kitchen table.

STEP BY STEP

1 BUILD THE HOLES
Paper cups on their sides.



2 ADD OBSTACLES
Books, boxes, a ramp.



3 PUTT
A ping-pong ball and a ruler or a small putter.



4 COUNT STROKES
Fewest strokes wins!



SCORECARD

Hole	Player 1	Player 2	Player 3	Player 4
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
TOTAL				

MATERIALS NEEDED



Paper cups



Ping-pong ball



A ruler or small putter



Books

CAREGIVER TIP

Play seated at the table so everyone can join.

SOUNDS ALIKE



These words sound the same but mean different things. Draw a line to match them.



sea



night



flower



our



knight



see



pair



flour



bee



pear



write



right



mail



be



hour



male

ANSWERS:
sea-see-flоаr · knight-night · pair-pear · bee-be · write-right · mail-male · hour-our
Figurrp - eqwer ·

SCHOOL DAYS

Ring the bell! Let's go back to the classroom.



REPORT CARD

My school ____

Favorite subject

Favorite teacher

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Share your memories! Take turns and see what you remember.

How did you get to school?



What did you bring for lunch?



Your best friend at school?



A teacher you'll never forget?



Were you ever in trouble?



Your favorite recess game?



What was graduation like?

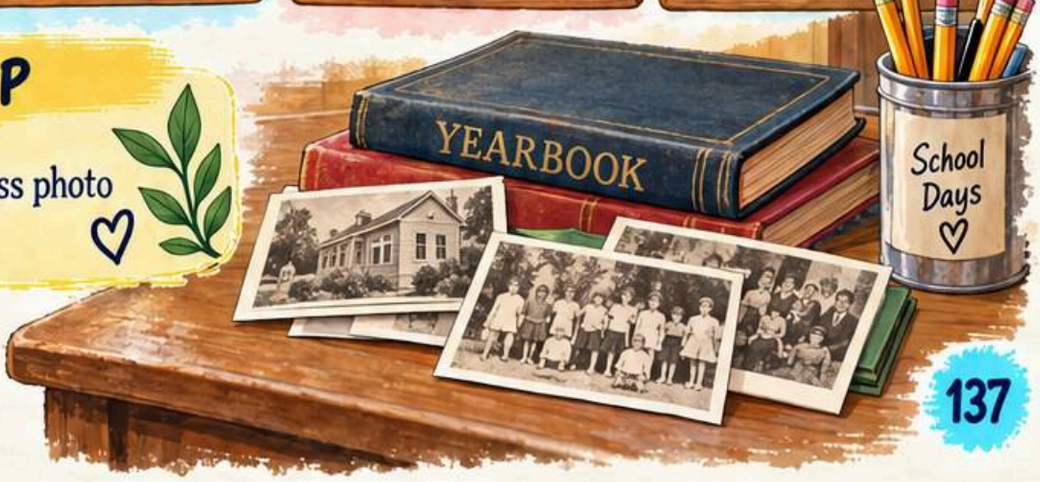


What would you tell your school-age self?



CAREGIVER TIP

Bring an old yearbook or class photo if you have one.



WEAVE A PLACEMAT

Over, under, over, under. A colorful placemat made by your own hands.



STEP BY STEP

1 FOLD & CUT

Fold a sheet in half and cut slits, leaving a border.



2 CUT STRIPS

Strips of a different color.



3 WEAVE

Over and under, then switch for the next strip.

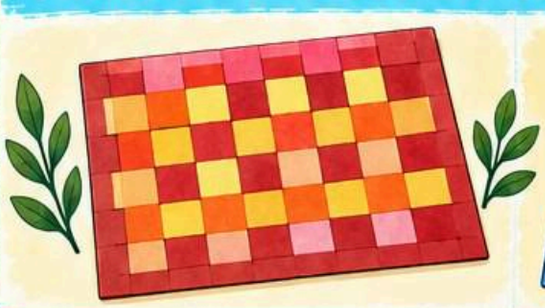


4 GLUE THE ENDS

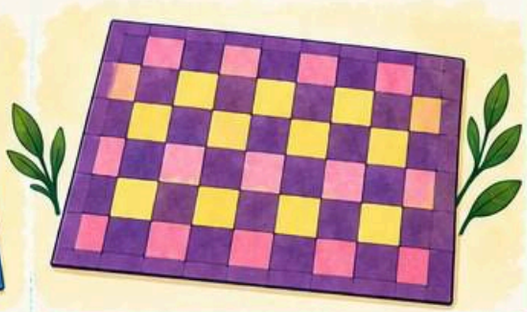
And use it at dinner!



FINISHED PLACEMAT IDEAS







MATERIALS NEEDED



Colored paper



Scissors



Glue stick



Ruler

CAREGIVER TIP

Pre-cut the slits and strips for tired hands.

FUNNY CAPTIONS

What are they thinking?
Write a funny caption under each picture!











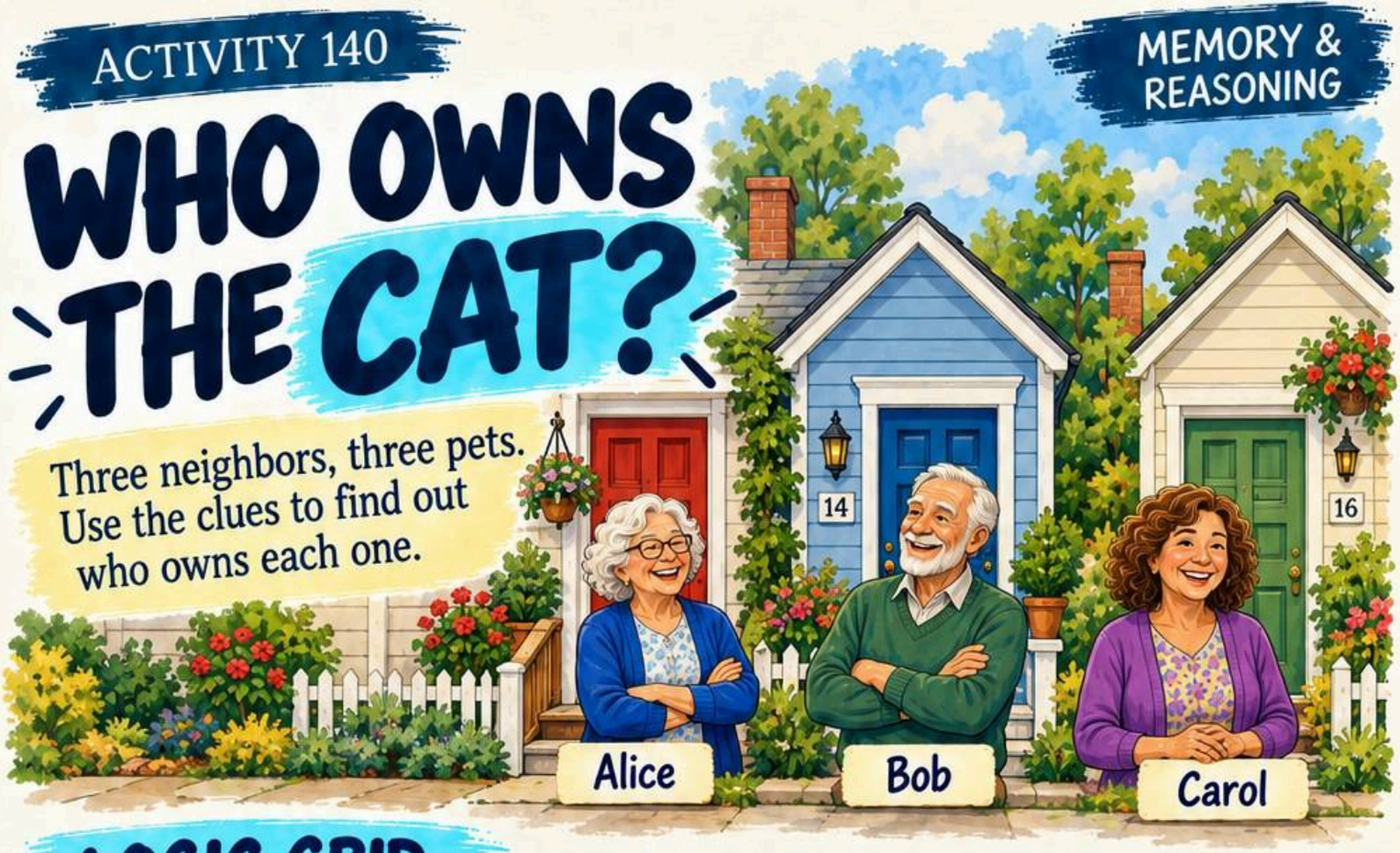




CAREGIVER TIP | Read the captions out loud and vote for the funniest.

WHO OWNS THE CAT?

Three neighbors, three pets. Use the clues to find out who owns each one.



LOGIC GRID

	Cat	Dog	Fish
Alice			
Bob			
Carol			

CLUES

1. Alice does not have a pet with fur.
2. Bob is allergic to cats.
3. Each neighbor has a different pet.

OUR ANSWERS

Alice has the [ ] · Bob has the [ ] · Carol has the [ ].

ANSWERS: Alice: fish · Bob: dog · Carol: cat

ACTIVITY 141

FAMILY CONNECTION ♡

HANDMADE GREETING CARDS



A card made by hand says 'I love you' twice. ♡

CARD IDEAS









STEP BY STEP

1 FOLD
A sheet of cardstock in half.



2 DECORATE
Stickers, flowers, drawings.



3 WRITE
A warm message inside.



4 SEND
Mail it or hand it with a hug.



MATERIALS NEEDED


Cardstock


Markers


Stickers


Glue stick


Pressed flowers

CAREGIVER TIP

Make a stack for upcoming birthdays in the family. ♡

ACTIVITY 142

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

SEATED DRUM CIRCLE



Feel the beat together! Rhythm wakes up the body and the mood.

RHYTHM PATTERNS

Try these rhythms. Clap or tap along!

1. BOOM - BOOM - CLAP



2. BOOM - CLAP - BOOM - CLAP



3. FAST - FAST - SLOW



4. Echo the leader!



STEP BY STEP

1. **GET A DRUM –** A bucket, a box or a pot.



2. **FOLLOW THE LEADER –** Copy the rhythm.



3. **TAKE TURNS –** Everyone invents a beat.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Plastic buckets or boxes



Wooden spoons



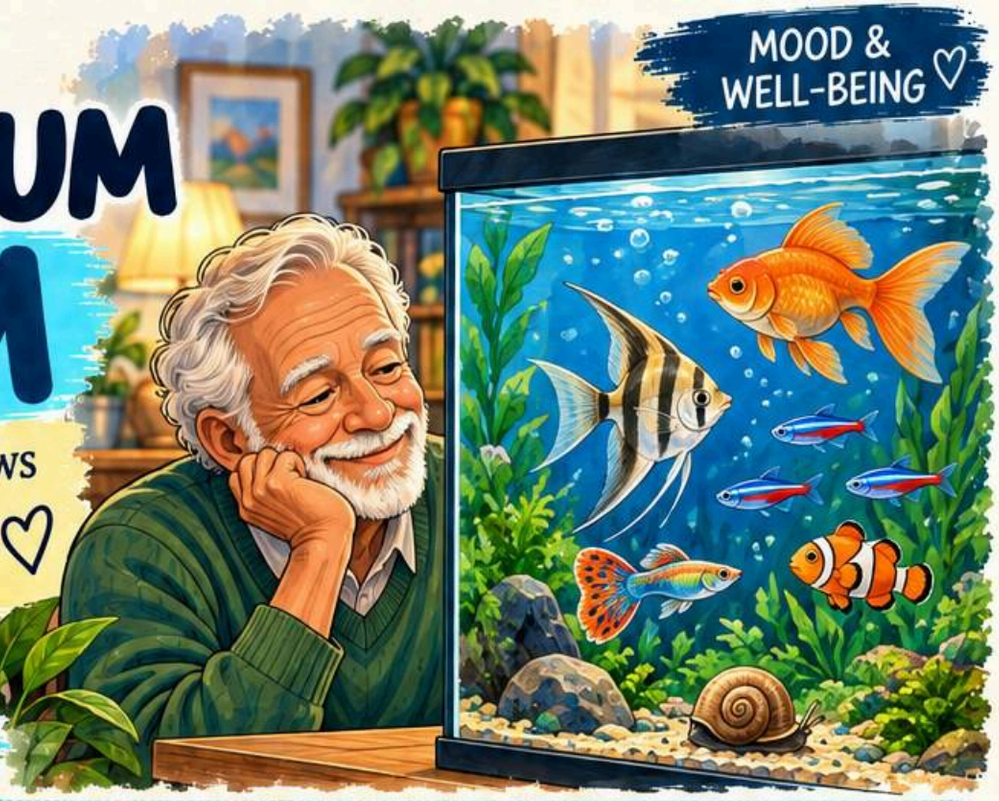
Music (optional)

CAREGIVER TIP

Keep the volume friendly and smile big: it's contagious!

AQUARIUM CALM

Watching fish swim slows the breath and quiets the mind. ♡



FISH TO SPOT



☐ Goldfish



☐ Angelfish



☐ Guppy



☐ Clownfish



☐ Neon tetra

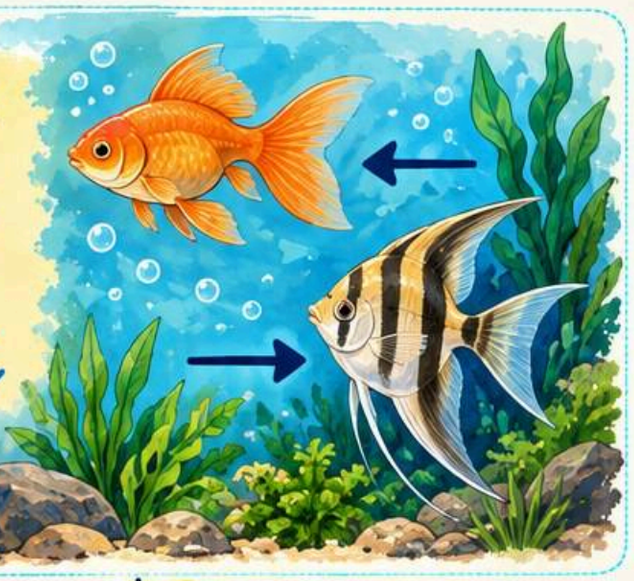


☐ Snail

CALM BREATHING



Breathe in as a fish swims left... breathe out as it swims right.



MORE WAYS TO ENJOY



Look for colors and patterns



Notice how the fish move



Find something new each time

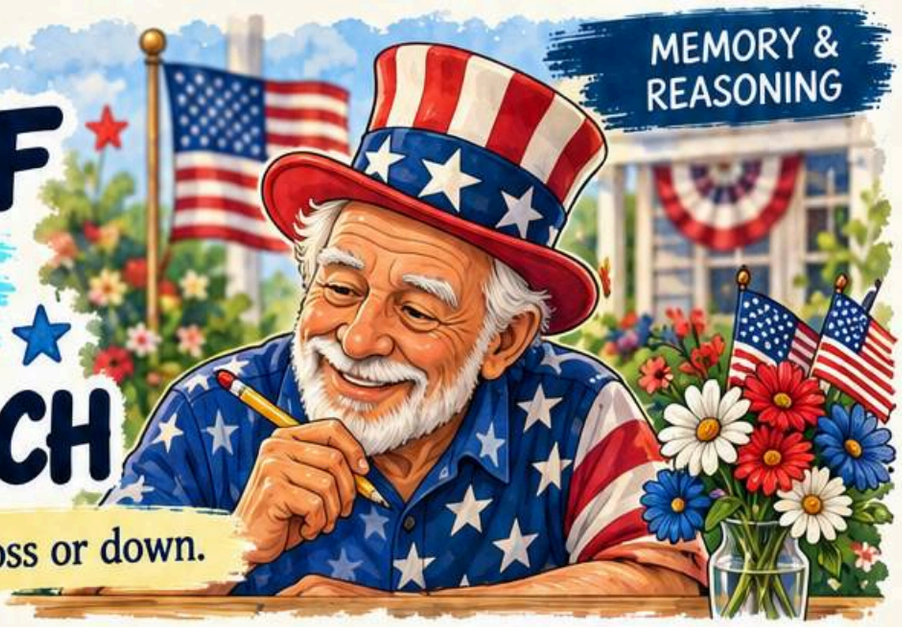


Let yourself feel relaxed

CAREGIVER TIP

No aquarium? Play a relaxing aquarium video on the TV. ♡

FOURTH OF JULY WORD SEARCH



Find the 10 words. They go across or down.

S	P	A	R	K	L	E	R	D	R	K	W
Y	F	F	U	P	I	O	O	K	D	K	F
E	I	R	P	P	B	A	N	N	E	R	P
C	R	E	C	A	E	F	B	O	W	L	A
I	E	E	W	E	R	H	L	C	I	V	R
W	W	D	H	O	T	D	O	G	A	K	A
N	O	O	K	E	Y	P	N	F	M	V	D
G	R	M	N	A	E	I	F	P	G	O	E
D	K	R	H	G	A	C	L	G	I	G	W
P	S	O	F	L	R	N	A	V	V	E	P
B	O	A	V	E	I	I	G	V	K	S	G
T	G	T	L	M	F	C	N	U	L	P	T

FIND THESE WORDS



FLAG ☐



PARADE ☐



PICNIC ☐



LIBERTY ☐



FIREWORKS ☐



EAGLE ☐



FREEDOM ☐



BANNER ☐



HOTDOG ☐



SPARKLER ☐



CAREGIVER TIP

Talk about the memories connected to each word. Recollection adds meaning and joy!

ACTIVITY 145

FAMILY CONNECTION

FAMILY PHOTO WALL



A wall full of faces you love.
Look at it every day and smile.

WALL LAYOUT IDEAS



Grid layout



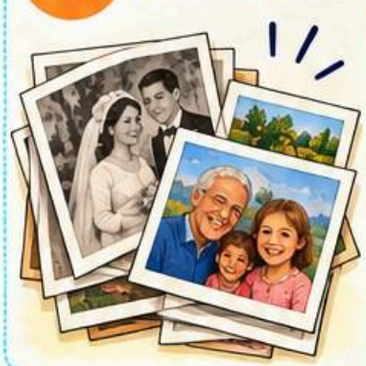
Heart layout



Family tree layout

STEP BY STEP

1 GATHER PHOTOS – Old and new.



2 PICK A LAYOUT – Grid, heart or tree.



3 HANG – String and clothespins or frames.



4 LABEL – Names and years on little tags.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Photos (copies)



String



Clothespins



Tape or frames

CAREGIVER TIP

Use copies, never the only original photo. ♡

ACTIVITY 146

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

TOWEL STRETCH

One towel, six easy stretches. Loosen up while sitting down.



1 OVERHEAD REACH

Lift the towel high.



2 SIDE LEAN

Lean left, then right.



3 CHEST OPENER

Towel behind your back, squeeze the shoulders.



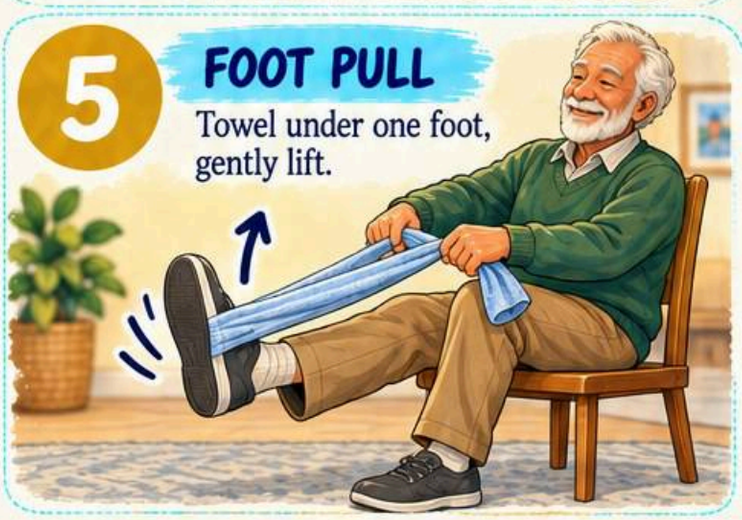
4 ROWING

Pull the towel toward your chest.



5 FOOT PULL

Towel under one foot, gently lift.



6 WRING IT OUT

Twist the towel like washing it.



CAREGIVER TIP

Move slowly and stop at a gentle stretch, never pain.

BUBBLE WRAP POP

Pop, pop, pop!
The simplest stress relief in the world.



3 FUN WAYS TO PLAY

1 Pop to the beat of a song

Play your favorite upbeat music and pop along to the rhythm.



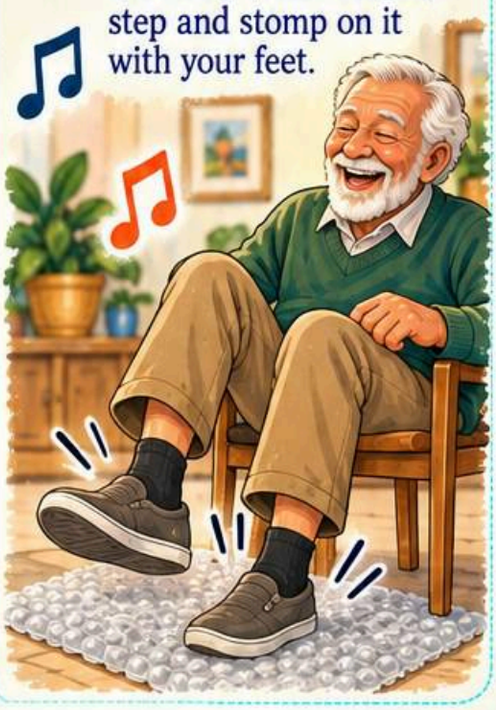
2 Pop only the bubbles in one row

Challenge yourself to pop just one row at a time. It's great for focus and mindfulness.



3 Step on it, seated, and stomp away

Place bubble wrap on the floor. While seated, step and stomp on it with your feet.



MATERIALS NEEDED



Bubble wrap



Upbeat music

CAREGIVER TIP

Big bubbles are easier for stiff fingers.



CLASSIC TV TRIVIA



Turn the dial back!
Circle the right answer.

1 Lucy's husband in "I Love Lucy" was...
A Ricky B Fred C Joe



2 Which show was set in Mayberry?
A The Andy Griffith Show B Gunsmoke C Bewitched



3 Samantha twitched her nose in...
A Bewitched B I Dream of Jeannie C Lassie



4 The Cleavers' younger son was...
A Beaver B Opie C Bobby



5 "Here's Johnny!" introduced...
A Johnny Carson B Johnny Cash C John Wayne



6 Which show had the Ponderosa ranch?
A Bonanza B M*A*S*H C Dragnet



7 The Brady family had how many kids?
A 4 B 6 C 8



8 "Ed Sullivan" hosted a...
A Variety show B Cooking show C Western



9 Which show had a starship called Enterprise?
A Star Trek B Lost in Space C Batman



10 Lassie was a...
A Dog B Horse C Cat



ANSWERS: 1A · 2A · 3A · 4A · 5A · 6A · 7B · 8A · 9A · 10A

THANK-YOU LETTERS

Gratitude written down becomes a treasure someone keeps forever.



Dear _____,

Thank you for...

_____

_____

_____

You make my life better because...

_____

_____

_____

With love, _____

Dear _____,

Thank you for...

_____

_____

_____

You make my life better because...

_____

_____

_____

With love, _____

CAREGIVER TIP

Help address and mail the letters. Reading the replies together is a joy.



ACTIVITY 150

MOVEMENT & COORDINATION

CLOTHESPIN CHALLENGE

Pinch, clip, match! A colorful challenge for strong, nimble fingers. ♡



3 LEVELS TO TRY

EASY: match colors



MEDIUM: clip as many as you can in 1 minute



HARD: clip in a pattern



STEP BY STEP

1 TIE A STRING
Between two chairs.



2 MARK COLORS
Colored dots along the string.



3 CLIP
Match each clothespin to its color.



4 TIME IT
Can you beat your record?



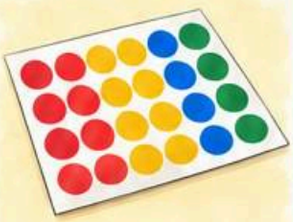
MATERIALS NEEDED



Colored clothespins



String



Colored dot stickers

CAREGIVER TIP

Larger clothespins are easier on the fingers. ♡

Congratulations! You've reached Activity 150!